

SPRING 2026 | M&W 3:05-4:20pm | Crowell Building Room 108 (Duke East Campus)

POLISCI 109

POLICE, PRISONS & POLITICS

First Year Constellation: *How does social control operate in the modern world?*

Instructor: Adriane Fresh, PhD

Pronouns: she/her

Email: adriane.fresh@duke.edu or adriane@adrianefresh.com

Office: 216 Gross Hall (northwest far corner of the 2nd floor)

Office Hours: via Calendly sign up link:

<https://calendly.com/adriane-adrianefresh/20min>

Affiliated Constellations Librarian: Adhitya Dhanapal, PhD

Email: adhitya.dhanapal@duke.edu

COURSE OVERVIEW

This course is about the politics of the police and the prison system with a

focus on the contemporary United States. The course addresses both substantive questions and introduces students to theories and methodologies that political scientists have used to study them. The course examines the topic of *social control* through the lens of formal institutions in an advanced industrial democracy.

The course is not a comprehensive overview of the politics of police and prisons, but instead achieves its learning goals via a deep dive into a carefully selected set of three topic modules. The topic modules are: the behavior of the police; the consequences of police and prison contact for political participation; and prison gerrymandering.

Each of these modules mirrors key questions posed in the study of American politics, and the politics of democracies more broadly: how does the *demos* shape the actions of its agents in government; why do people choose to participate in democratic politics; and how do geography and policy shape who can participate and how much democratic power they exert over representatives.

The learning goals in each of these modules emphasize foundational social science skills around reading, note-taking, question asking and analysis. I aim for you to finish this class with a strong sense of disciplinary practice—what it looks like for a *political scientist* to study key features of social control in the modern United States—and with a cultivated curiosity for learning more.

MODULE 1 Police Behavior

What explains the behavior of the police, especially their use of force? Why do the police sometimes protect and serve; while at other times they can coerce and even kill? This module addresses questions of police behavior by considering how institutions can and cannot produce accountability.

Big idea: Bureaucratic discretion is difficult to constrain.

MODULE 2 Carceral Contact and Political Participation

How does contact with the police and prison system affect people's willingness and ability to participate in politics? This module considers questions about why individuals participate in politics, and how coming into contact with the police or prison system might change individual's desire and capacity to participate.

Big idea: The *demos* is made and re-made through its institutions.

MODULE 3 Prison Gerrymandering

Where are incarcerated populations represented? And how does that representation shape the distribution of government resources? This module considers the spatial distribution of incarcerated populations and how democracy distributes resources and shapes inequality as a result.

Big idea: Modern government is inescapably spatial.

OUR CLASSROOM COMMUNITY

It's important to be aware that we will cover topics in this course that are very sensitive, and others that may be highly personal. Together, we will work hard to cultivate a classroom environment that allows our presentation and discussions of these topics to be both intellectually rigorous and sensitive to differing opinions and perspectives. In being sensitive, however, we will not police each others thoughts, words or actions—nor self-police our own—but instead we'll keep our minds open, offer reasons for our views, whatever they may be, and be courageous in sharing, because that sharing is an intellectual gift we give to each other.

Like any instructor, I am not a neutral arbiter, devoid of personal opinion and perspective. Nor is my perspective anything beyond my own. But as an instructor, one of the skills that I have is significant *practice* in recognizing my own opinions and perspectives, and embodying different opinions at different times in order to present alternative arguments—ones you may not agree with! and ones vastly different from my own!—deliberately challenging your beliefs.

As the subsequent section describes, the learning goals of this class do not ask you to hold particular views on police, prisons or politics in the United States, nor to change the beliefs that you currently hold. Instead, the intellectual aims of our class center around the application of a social scientific approach to studying these potentially sensitive and personal topics. This social scientific approach builds skills that allow you to understand, as best as possible *why the world works as it does*. This is different and distinct from questions of how the world *should* look. But the two are not unrelated—by understanding why the world looks as it does, you'll gain a firm foundation from which to craft (in this course and beyond) your own sense of what the world *should* look like.

To succeed in class, what I ask is that you are willing to learn about, and actively practice, the perspective that a social scientist takes. Whether you adopt that perspective going forward is up to you.

LEARNING GOALS

Learning goals constitute the concrete, transferrable skills that you will obtain as a consequence of this course. By the end of the course, you will be able to:

1. *Question.* You will be able to generate thoughtful, open-ended questions that deepen your understanding of complex issues, and you will practice doing so in ways that cultivate and sustain your own intellectual curiosity.
2. *Understand.* You will be able to read for big ideas, author motivations, evidentiary support, and explicit/implicit assumptions in individual social science texts.
3. *Describe.* You will be able to describe concrete facts and empirical patterns related to each of the topic modules.
4. *Explain.* You will be able to explain the logic of social scientific frameworks that aim to address *why* the world exhibits those patterns. In turn, you'll be able to apply those explanatory frameworks to the empirical patterns described above.
5. *Apply.* You will be able to describe core disciplinary practices of political science by distinguishing positive questions from normative ones, and apply this distinction to the formulation and assessment of political arguments and research.
6. *Perspective-Take.* You will be able to conduct ethical inquiry by articulating and examining arguments from diverse perspectives, not necessarily your own, in a way that deepens your capacity for thoughtful, open-minded engagement with contested issues.
7. *Create.* You will be able to create your own politically-relevant products.

ASSIGNMENTS

The following assignments are designed to help you to achieve the above learning goals. **Please note:** the full details of each assignment are provided on the course's website. In order to optimally complete the assignment, you must consult those instructions, not just the descriptions below.

Notebook (20%)

DUE: Multiple check-ins via images uploaded to Canvas

The ability to read effectively and maintain effective notes is one of the most powerful and transferrable skills that you can obtain as an undergraduate. One of the challenges is that effective reading is rarely taught. This class aims to give you effective note-taking skills that will serve you well beyond this class.

To learn to take good notes, you will keep a Notebook (this assignment) for our class. This notebook will contain your reading notes and your in-class notes. These will be hand-written (more on that below), and they will be graded at four check ins throughout the term.

“Moment of Curiosity”: In order to cultivate curiosity, each class we will take a few minutes to reflect on what we’ve learned and write in our “notebooks” at least two good questions that deepen and extend the material we’ve covered that day (and/or up to that date). One question will be positive: *it will be a question about the way the world works, where presumably there is a “true” answer that we could possibly discover.* The other question will be normative: *it will be a question about shoulds and oughts where there is no true answer.*

Quizzes (16%)

DUE: Periodically at the beginning of class

If you stay ready, you don’t have to get ready. Learning is not well achieved when you rush to retain a lot of information—you know, by *cramming for the test*. So, in this class, there will be frequent quizzes that take place during class that are designed to ensure that you are constantly keeping up with the readings and reviewing material. These quizzes will cover content from the

readings and from class discussion. The quizzes will be frequent enough that my hope is that you never feel like any single question is overly decisive for your grade and you get used to the process of taking them. Your lowest quiz score will be dropped.

Politically-Relevant Product Assignment — Map Analysis (20%)

DUE: TBD (via Canvas)

In this assignment, you will produce between one and three maps that display information about incarcerated populations and political boundaries in a state of your choosing. These will be map(s) that you design and produce yourself based on GIS skills that you acquire during class and which follow key principles on how to properly present visual information.

Accompanying your map(s) will be descriptive map analysis essay. Your accompanying essay will be written for someone unfamiliar with prison gerrymandering and will offer an explanation of the phenomenon in general, in your state, and use the maps that you've made to explain who (appears to) benefits and who loses from the prison gerrymandering in your state.

Perspective Papers (24% total; 8%, 8%, 8% each)

DUE: #1 Thursday 2/16 by class time via Canvas; #2 Thursday 3/16 by class time via Canvas; #3 Thursday 4/20 by class time via Canvas

In this assignment, you will complete three separate papers of 3-5 pages each. Each paper will be associated with a given module. The papers ask you to respond to a claim relevant to the module content. You will be randomly assigned to write an essay in support or in opposition to the claim. You will draw on course readings, locate an additional high quality source, and build a set of reasons with evidence that support your assigned position. You will conclude by drawing a normative implication that follows from your claim.

Perspective papers will be due at class time and there will be no assigned readings for those class days. Students will take a 20 minute walk with a student who was assigned the opposing position on the claim to talk through how each of them supported their claim and how their positions contrast.

PARTICIPATION (20%)

We enrich our understanding of material by engaging with it together; learning from the insights of others; and pushing ourselves to reflect, question and respond when others have different understandings, perspectives and values

about the world.

Therefore, a significant portion of your grade will depend on whether you have completed course readings, and your willingness and ability to engage in classroom activities, contribute to discussions, listen to your peers, and actively engage with me and them. Students should recognize that skimming readings is insufficient to achieve quality participation. Rather, I expect all students **not only to have completed readings prior to class, but to have also *thought* about them and *reflected* on them.** This does not require full comprehension, but it does necessitate attentiveness. When you do not comprehend the reading fully, you must be attentive to *what* you do not comprehend, and be willing to bring those questions to class.

As a reference point, simply attending every class merits a ‘C’ grade. No joke. Simply saying one thing per class in addition, really isn’t much better (C+ probably?). This should give you a clear indication that I have extremely high expectations for participation. Active listening is indeed important, but being merely a completely passive presence is not for this class.

At the midway point in class, I will ask you complete a short survey with the participation grade that you think, based on how you have participated up to that point, you deserve to receive. This gives you an opportunity to reflect on your own participation and the expectations of the class; not to simply be told how you are doing. However, I will respond to your survey with information about your progress, and what you can do to improve.

Absences: Absences for documented illness or university-approved activities (sports) are allowed. Otherwise, you are expected to be in class each day. One unexcused absence will be unlikely to affect your participation if you participate well when you are present. More unexcused absences will likely impact your participation. I’ll take attendance each day when I record participation grades (unexcused absences are a 0; excused absences change the denominator of your grade; i.e., the day is dropped). There is no direct make up for missed classes. You can ask fellow students for notes to find out what happened.

EXTRA CREDIT (Up to 2% in total)

There are two ways of earning extra credit in this class. First, is the Selfie way. Each selfie is worth 0.2% extra towards your grade. Submit a selfie of yourself at politically-relevant locations in Durham to Canvas. Duck face optional, hah hah.

1. Durham County Detention Facility
2. Durham City Hall

3. Durham Police Department Headquarters
4. Durham County Commissioners
5. Durham County Board of Elections (yes, it is farther)

Second, there is the Office Hours way. You may earn 1.0% of extra credit towards your grade by visiting me in office hours. Applies to your first visit only; additional visits fun but no extra credit. What to talk to me about in office hours? If you have an issue in class, then certainly that. But even if you don't, we can talk about your "Moment of Curiosity" questions. We can talk about political science as a major. We can talk about career paths after Duke. Office Hours isn't just for people who are struggling!

Note: Extra credit may not be used to raise your grade above an A. That is, you cannot earn an A+ from extra credit.

EXPERIENTIAL ACTIVITIES

As a First Year Constellation course, there are two scheduled and required experiential activities this term. These activities give us the opportunity to take our learning outside of the classroom. The first is a re-entry simulation taking place on **Saturday, 2/21 from 12-3 in Brodie Gym**. The second is a project share session on **Thursday, 4/16, time and location TBD**. In the case of each of these activities, attendance is part of your participation grade, and additional follow up assignments (notebook notes) will be incorporated.

LATE ASSIGNMENTS

I expect assignments to be turned in on time. Meeting deadlines is a critical "soft skill" in life. Assignments are due precisely when specified. Assignments will lose 1/3 of a letter grade (e.g. an assignment otherwise graded a B+ will be graded a B) for each 24 hours they are late unless we discuss in advance.

I understand, however, that life happens, and even when we have the best of intentions, unexpected things can happen, or we can fall behind and need a little help and compassion. If you are struggling to complete a given assignment on time, please reach out **before the due date**, if at all possible, to discuss how to complete the assignment in a way that won't affect in-class

activities or snow-ball into further late assignments.

GRADING

Letter grades reflect your progress towards the learning goals outlined in a previous section of this syllabus. They are **not** measures of effort, but instead are designed to capture your learning. They follow a standard format:

98-100 A+	88-80.9 B+	78-79.9 C+	60-70 D
93-97.9 A	83-87.9 B	73-77.9 C	below 60 D
90-92.9 A-	80-82.9 B-	70-72.9 C-	

Cultivating a Growth Mindset

With all marks—whether on individual assignments or in the course overall—I strongly encourage you take a growth mindset. A growth mindset requires that you believe that your abilities are not fixed based on some immutable notion of intelligence or talent, but are instead under your control to develop and improve through dedication and hard work. If you receive a top mark, this doesn't mean that there isn't more to do and more to learn. Similarly, if you receive a low mark, this is in no way a referendum on your intelligence or your potential. Instead, it is a component of constructive feedback that is designed, with targeted feedback, to help you do better in the future.

THE HONOR CODE & AUTHORSHIP

Duke is a community dedicated to scholarship, leadership, and service and to the principles of honesty, fairness, respect, and accountability. Citizens of this community commit to reflect upon and uphold these principles in all academic and nonacademic endeavors, and to protect and promote a culture of integrity.

To uphold the Duke Community Standard:

1. I will not lie, cheat, or steal in my academic endeavors;
2. I will conduct myself honorably in all my endeavors; and
3. I will act if the Standard is compromised.

For more on the Duke Community Standard, please visit:

<https://studentaffairs.duke.edu/conduct/about-us/duke-community-standard>

On AI, Authorship and the Honor Code

My expectations for how you may use of AI (e.g., Chat GPT) follow the suggestions of the university:

1. Generally speaking, while you may use AI as a tool to assist you in your writing process, it may *not* be used as a replacement for your own critical thinking and writing skills. You should always be the primary author of your work and use AI to supplement and enhance your own ideas and your own communication of those ideas.
2. If you use AI to generate text, you *must* properly cite the source in your assignment. Failure to do so is considered plagiarism. For example, if you use ChatGPT to generate text that you use verbatim, you must quote the generated text, and use the appropriate in-text citation format (e.g., footnote, endnote, in-line parenthetical) depending on which format you have chosen to use, and cite the tool in your formal reference list. If you generate text and adapt it (that is, paraphrase from it), you do not need to use quotations, but you must still cite the tool as described above. If you use AI only to edit your spelling/grammar (e.g., Grammarly) you should not cite the tool.
3. Do not use AI to complete assignments that are meant to be original works. If an assignment requires you to demonstrate your own critical thinking or problem-solving skills, using AI to generate the entire response would be considered a violation of Duke's Honor Code.

The assignments in this class ask you to produce original works that demonstrate your own critical thinking and problem-solving skills. AI may not be used to substitute for these components of your process.

I will compare your completed essays with an essay generated by AI with a prompt that reflects your chosen topic and the basic assignment parameters, and I will utilize a AI detection software. In order to uphold the university honor code, I will have to initiate a plagiarism case in the event the above

guidelines are not followed.

RESOURCES

Appointments

My office hours are listed on the first page of the syllabus. If you have a conflict with those office hours, you can schedule an appointment with me via email. Just ask!

Please be *prepared* when you meet with me—make sure you know exactly what you want to gain from the meeting. If you have a brief question, you can ask over email instead. You can expect to receive a response within 48 hours.

Mental Health

Undergraduate study is ideally designed to stretch and build your intellectual abilities. Doing so necessitates criticism (though ideally constructive). For many students who have aced school since day one, this is some of the very first true experiences of criticism that they've had, and it can be difficult. Undergraduate education also necessitates balancing many deadlines, learning how to set priorities and how to be OK with the inability to do everything perfectly.

To encounter these challenges means that taking care of your mental health. Learning skills to manage stress, anxiety, criticism and disappointment will make you happier in life overall and a more successful student. If the burdens of study ever become too much, reach out to someone, anyone.

Contacts

Academic Resource Center

Find tutors, build your academic skills.
(919) 684-5917
theARC@duke.edu or arc.duke.edu

Thompson Writing Program

Schedule an appointment to discuss ways to improve as a writer.

<https://twp.duke.edu/>

Student Disability Access Office (SDAO)

For registration of accommodation needs and any other support.
sdao@duke.edu or access.duke.edu

Counseling and Psychological Services (CAPS)

Make counseling appointments and seek referrals to outside therapists.
(919) 660-1000
<https://students.duke.edu/wellness/caps/CAPS>

TimelyCare (formerly Blue Devils Care)

Convenient, confidential, and free online mental health support.
bluedevilscore.duke.edu

DISABILITY ACCOMMODATION

Students with a documented disability should present me with their accommodation letter from the SDAO (see resources above) at their earliest ability. This letter allows me to follow university policy that accommodates disabilities while also protecting student privacy.

Students who need to obtain a letter are encouraged to reach out to SDAO *as soon as possible* and make sure that their instructor is informed that a letter can be expected at a later date. I cannot make accommodations based on a requested accommodation, only one that has been approved by the SDAO. Please make plans to obtain such accommodations in a timely manner.

COMMUNICATION

I will use email—both independently and through Canvas—to communicate with you outside of class. **I expect that you will check your email regularly and respond promptly (within 48 hours of receipt of an**

personally-addressed email that requires your action or acknowledgement).

Relatedly, please email me to communicate about any class topics. I pledge to respond to your email within 48 hours of receipt. Therefore, if you have a time-sensitive question related to a deadline, please plan ahead and ask your question with enough time for me to respond.

READINGS

All readings, unless specifically noted, can be found under the ‘Files’ tab and the relevant module week on the course’s Canvas site. I expect you to undertake the readings prior to the class session for which they are listed. I aim to assign no more than 50 pages of reading per class, but usually it will be less. As our course goals involve cultivating reading skills, the quality of our reading rather than the quantity is our collective priority.

Many readings are selections that are excerpted from a longer book, article or report. If you are interested in the full article, particularly if you are using the article in an assignment, please use the library to obtain the full copy.

PRELIMINARY SCHEDULE OVERVIEW

Week	Date	Class Topic	Assignment
1	W 1/7	** No Class **	
		Module 1: Police Behavior	
2	M 1/12	Introduction	
2	W 1/14	How do the Police Behave?	
3	M 1/19	** No Class (MLK Holiday) **	
3	W 1/21	Police as Bureaucrats	
4	M 1/26	Recruitment & Socialization	
4	W 1/28	<i>Guest Speaker</i>	
5	M 2/2	Accountability for Crime	
5	W 2/4	Accountability to Whom?	
6	M 2/9	Law Enforcement as Principals	
6	W 2/11	Experiments in Police Reform	
7	M 2/16	<i>Reflection Day</i>	DUE: Perspective Paper #1 (by class)
		Module 2: Participation and Carceral Contact	
7	W 2/18	Carceral Contact	
7	S 2/21	** Experiential Activity **	Activity: Re-entry Simulation (Brodie Gym, 12-3pm)
8	M 2/23	Who Participates in Politics?	
8	W 2/25	Carceral Contact De-Mobilizes	
8	F 2/27		DUE: Participation Self-Evaluation
9	M 3/2	Carceral Contact Mobilizes	
9	W 3/4	Participation Beyond Voting	
10	M 3/9	** No Class (Spring Break) **	
10	W 3/11	** No Class (Spring Break) **	
11	M 3/16	<i>Reflection Day</i>	DUE: Perspective Paper #2 (by class)
		Module 3: Prison Gerrymandering	
11	W 3/18	Geography of Imprisonment	
12	M 3/23	Drawing Political Boundaries	
12	W 3/25	Prison Gerrymandering	
13	M 3/30	<i>GIS Workshop</i>	
13	W 4/1	<i>GIS Workshop</i>	
14	M 4/6	Strategic Gerrymandering	
14	W 4/8	Distributive Consequences	
15	M 4/13	<i>Guest Speaker</i>	
15	W 4/15	Reforming Gerrymandering	
15	Th 4/16	** Experiential Activity **	DUE/Activity: Map Poster
16	M 4/20	<i>Reflection Day</i>	DUE: Perspective Paper #3 (by class)
	TBD	DUE: Final Map Assignment	

SCHEDULE

WEEK 1

Class 1 — W 1/7 — ** NO CLASS **

No readings.

WEEK 2

Class 1 — M 1/12 — Introduction

No Readings.

MODULE 1: Police Behavior

Class 2 — W 1/14 — How do the Police Behave?

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Shively (2012). *The Craft of Research*. 9th edition. **(10 pages)**
2. Levin (2024). "US police use force on 300,000 people a year with numbers rising since George Floyd: 'relentless violence.'" *The Guardian*. **(4 pages)**
3. Garner and Maxwell (2024). "Measuring the Use of Force Used By and Against the Police in Six Jurisdictions." **(20 pages)**
4. Walker et. al. (2001). "Early Warning Systems: Responding to the Problem Police Officer." **(8 pages)**

WEEK 3

Class 1 — M 1/19 — ** NO CLASS (MLK HOLIDAY) **

Class 2 — W 1/21 — Police as Bureaucrats

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Soss and Weaver (2017). "Police Are Our Government." *Annual Review of Political Science*. **(7 pages)**
2. Lipsky (1969). "Toward a Theory of Street-level Bureaucracy." *Institute for Research on Poverty Discussion Paper*. **(24 pages)**

WEEK 4

Class 1 — Th 1/26 — Recruitment, Training & Socialization

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Oberfield (2014). "Socialization and Self-Selection: How Police Officers Develop Their Views About Using Force." *Administration and Society*. **(15 pages)**
2. Moskos (2008). "Chapter 1: The Departed." *Cop in the Hood*. **(19 pages)**
3. Moskos (2008). "Chapter 2: Back to School: The Police Academy." *Cop in the Hood*. **(20 pages)**

Class 2 — W 1/28 — Guest Speakers: Officer Daryl Mount & Officer Aaron Pruka, Duke University Police Department

No readings.

WEEK 5

Class 1 — M 2/2 — Accountability for Crime

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Gramlich (2024). "What the data says about crime in the U.S." *Pew Research Center*. (8 pages)
2. Beckett (1994). "Setting the Public Agenda: 'Street Crime' and Drug Use in American Politics." (9 pages)
3. Arnold and Carnes (2012). "Holding Mayors Accountable." *American Journal of Political Science*. (16 pages)

Class 2 — W 2/4 — Accountability to Whom?

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Forman Jr. (2018). "Introduction." *Locking Up Our Own*. (14 pages)
2. Forman Jr. (2018). "'The worst thing to hit us since slavery': crack and the advent of warrior policing, 1988-92." *Locking Up Our Own*. (22 pages)
3. Hinton et. al. (2016). "Did Blacks Really Endorse the 1994 Crime Bill?" *The New York Times*. (3 pages)
4. Jefferson, Neuner and Pasek (2021). "Seeing Blue in Black and White: Race and Perceptions of Officer-Involved Shootings." *Perspectives on Politics*. (15 pages)

WEEK 6

Class 1 — M 2/9 — Law Enforcement as the Principal

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Robinson and Rushin (2022). “The Law Enforcement Lobby.” *Minnesota Law Review*. (23 pages)
2. Gonzalez (2023). “Reforming to Avoid Reform: Strategic Policy Substitution and the Reform Gap in Policing.” *Perspectives on Politics*. (5 pages)
3. Anzia (2011). “Election Timing and the Electoral Influence of Interest Groups.” *Journal of Politics*. (8 pages)

Class 2 — W 2/11 — Four Experiments in Police Reform

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Engel et. al. (2022). “Assessing the impact of de-escalation training on police behavior: Reducing police use of force in the Louisville, KY Metro Police Department.” *Criminology and Public Policy*. (11 pages)
2. Ariel, Farrar, Sutherland (2015). “The Effect of Police Body-Worn Cameras on Use of Force and Citizens’ Complaints Against the Police: A Randomized Controlled Trial.” *Journal of Quantitative Criminology*. (17 pages)
3. Mummolo (2017). “Modern Police Tactics, Police-Citizen Interactions, and the Prospects for Reform” *Journal of Politics*. (11 pages)
4. Landergan (2020). “The City that Really Did Abolish the Police.” *Politico*. (13 pages)

★ **Extra Credit Reading:** Billman (2023). “Durham’s HEART Model is Poised to Expand; What Are City Leaders Willing to Pay?” *IndyWeek*.

WEEK 7

Class 1 — M 2/16 — *Reflection*

★ **DUE:** Perspective Paper #1 by class ★

No readings.

MODULE 2: The Participatory Consequences of Carceral Contact

Class 2 — W 2/18 — **The Nature of Carceral Contact**

Readings to be completed before class:

1. BJS (2022). "Special Report: Contacts Between Police and the Public." **(13 pages)**
2. Turney and Connor (2019). "Jail Incarceration: A Common and Consequential Form of Criminal Justice Contact." *Annual Review of Criminology*. **(13 pages)**
3. Beckett and Goldberg (2022). "The Effects of Imprisonment in a Time of Mass Incarceration." *Crime and Justice*. **(23 pages)**
4. Weaver and Gellner (2024). "De-Policing America's Youth." *Crime and Justice*. **(8 pages)**

WEEK 8

Class 1 — M 2/25 — Who Participates in Politics?

Readings to be completed before class:

1. van Deth (2014). “A conceptual map of political participation.” *Acta Politica* (15 pages)
2. Verba et. al. (1995). “Beyond SES: A Resource Model of Political Participation.” *American Political Science Review*. (15 pages)

Class 2 — W 2/25 — Carceral Contact De-Mobilizes

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Pierson (1993). “When Effect Becomes Cause: Policy Feedback and Political Change.” *World Politics* (excerpt) (5 pages)
2. Weaver and Lerman (2014). “Political Consequences of the Carceral State.” *American Political Science Review*. (14 pages)
3. Sugie (2015). “Chilling Effects: Diminished Political Participation among Partners of Formerly Incarcerated Men.” *Social Problems*. (16 pages)

★ **DUE:** Participation Self-Eval, Friday 2/27 by midnight via Canvas ★

WEEK 9

Class 1 — M 3/2 — Carceral Contact Mobilizes

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Christiani and Shoub (2022). "Can Light Contact with the Police Motivate Political Participation?" *Journal of Race, Ethnicity and Politics*. (16 pages)
2. Walker (2014) "Extending the Effects of the Carceral State" *Political Research Quarterly*. (11 pages)

Class 2 — W 3/4 — Participation Beyond Voting

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Owens and Walker (2018). "The Civic Voluntarism of Custodial Citizens: Involuntary Criminal Justice Contact, Associational Life, and Political Participation." *Perspectives on Politics*. (16 pages)
2. Lerman and Weaver (2014). "Staying out of Sight? Concentrated Policing and Local Political Action." *Annals of the American Political Science Society*. (15 pages)

WEEK 10

Class 1 — Tu 3/11 — ** NO CLASS (SPRING BREAK) **

Class 2 — Th 3/16 — ** NO CLASS (SPRING BREAK) **

WEEK 11

Class 1 — Tu 3/16 — *Reflection Day*

★ **DUE:** Perspective Paper #2 by class ★

No readings.

MODULE 3: Prison Gerrymandering

Class 2 — Th 3/18 — Geography of Imprisonment

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Widra (2023). “Where people in prison come from: The geography of mass incarceration.” Prison Policy Initiative. <https://www.prisonpolicy.org/origin/2020report.html>
2. Wagner and Kopf (2015). “The racial geography of mass incarceration.” Prison Policy Initiative. <https://www.prisonpolicy.org/racialgeography/report.html>
3. Lawrence and Travis. “The New Landscape of Imprisonment.” *Urban Institute*. (20 pages)
4. Keller and Pierce (2016). “A Small Indiana County Sends More People to Prison Than San Francisco and Durham, N.C., Combined. Why?” *The New York Times*. <https://www.nytimes.com/2016/09/02/upshot/new-geography-of-prisons.html> (4 pages)

WEEK 12

Class 1 — M 3/23 — Drawing Political Boundaries

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Spencer. "Where are the lines drawn?" *All about redistricting*. <https://redistricting.lls.edu/redistricting-101/where-are-the-lines-drawn/> (5 pages)
2. MIT Election Lab. "Redistricting." <https://electionlab.mit.edu/research/redistricting> (3 pages)
3. McGee (2020). "Partisan Gerrymandering and Political Science." *Annual Review of Political Science*. (12 pages)
4. Canon (2022). "Race and Redistricting." *Annual Review of Political Science*. (5 pages)

Class 2 — W 3/25 — Prison Gerrymandering

★ **DUE:** Install QGIS by class ★

Readings to be completed before class:

1. DOJ (2024). "Guide to State Voting Rules That Apply After a Criminal Conviction." (Read about 3 states)
2. Ebenstein (2018). "The Geography of Mass Incarceration: Prison Gerrymandering and the Dilution of Prisoners' Political Representation." *The Fordham Urban Law Journal*. (10 pages)
3. Hamsher (2005). "Counted Out Twice." *Journal of Criminal Law and Criminology*. (30 pages)

WEEK 13

Class 1 — M 3/30 — Guest Visit: Using GIS Tutorial with Drew Keener,
Duke Librarian

Videos to be watched before class:

1. Forrest. "What is Spatial Data? A beginners guide" <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QMmk49KTCxk> (9 minutes)
2. Forrest. "Learn GIS — QGIS Full Course for Beginners (New For 2025)." <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=SovdBaus7pM> (First 23 minutes only)

Class 2 — W 3/25 — Guest Visit: Using GIS Tutorial with Drew Keener,
Duke Librarian

No readings.

WEEK 14

Class 1 — M 4/8 — Strategic Gerrymandering

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Remster and Kramer (2018). "Shifting Power: The impact of incarceration on political representation." *Du Bois Review*. (13 pages)
2. Kelly (2012). "The strategic use of prisons in partisan gerrymandering." *Legislative Studies Quarterly*. (18 pages)

Class 2 — W 4/8 — Distributive Consequences of Gerrymandering

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Lotke and Wagner (2004). "Prisoners of the Census: Electoral and Financial Consequences of Counting Prisoners Where They Go, Not Where They Come From." *Pace Law Review*. (10 pages)
2. King (2003). "Big Prisons, Small Towns: Prison Economics in Rural America." *Sentencing Project*. (19 pages)

WEEK 15

Class 1 — M 4/13 — Guest Speaker: Hilary Harris Klein, Senior Council for Voting Rights at the Southern Coalition for Social Justice (SoCSJ)

No readings.

Class 2 — W 4/15 — Reforming Prison Gerrymandering

Readings to be completed before class:

1. Fenster (2021). "How many states have ended prison gerrymandering? About a dozen*!" *Prison Policy Initiative*. (2 pages)
2. Wood (2014). "Implementing Reform: How Maryland and New York Ended Prison Gerrymandering." *Demos*. (15 pages)
3. Williamson and King (2022). "Redistricting and incarceration: Examining the electoral consequences of New York's prohibition on prison gerrymandering." *State Politics and Policy Quarterly*. (10 pages)

★ **DUE 4/16:** Map Poster (Experiential Activity) ★

WEEK 16

Class 1 — Tu 4/20 — Reflection Day

★ **DUE:** Perspective Paper #3 by class ★

No readings.